

Saturday, 26 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 20° 14°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 19° 10°	MANCHESTER Overcast 18° 10°	GLASGOW Drizzle 17° 12°
-------------------------------	-----------------------------------	-----------------------------------	-------------------------------

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

The Prime Minister has ruled out a snap general election, saying it would only throw the country into a 'backward-looking process'.

Andy Burnham told the BBC he isn't tempted to call an early poll. He believes the focus should be on the country's future, not on campaigning.

POLITICS · UK
- 2

A Welsh police force has warned that a recent cyber attack may have 'compromised' information belonging to its staff.

Dyfed-Powys Police say they don't believe any personal data relating to the public was accessed. An investigation is now underway to determine the full extent of the breach.

CYBER SECURITY · UK
- 3

No action has been taken against an Iranian man who attempted to enter the UK's nuclear submarine base earlier this year.

The 34-year-old was arrested in March after trying to access the Faslane base in Argyll and Bute. It's home to the Royal Navy's nuclear submarine fleet.

DEFENCE · UK
- 4

Two men have been charged after police discovered an estimated ten million pounds worth of ketamine in a village.

Police say the drugs were found in black bin bags. It's believed to be one of the largest hauls of the drug ever found in the UK.

CRIME · UK
- 5

An inquest has heard that a young boy left a playground through a gap in a fence before he was tragically killed.

Noah Woods' mother has urged other parents to 'hold their children a little tighter and cherish every moment'. The inquest continues.

TRAGEDY · UK

What's coming up

1 The Turner Prize exhibition opens today, with work by four artists going on display in London.

The prestigious art prize celebrates contemporary art, and the gallery is being hailed as a 'centre of the creative universe'. The winner will be announced later this year.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of modern art, or do you prefer something more traditional?

ART · THIS WEEKEND

2 The shortlist for this year's Booker Prize has been revealed, with two past winners among the nominees.

Marlon James and Douglas Stuart are both in the running for the prestigious literary award. Judges described the selection process as a 'tussle' due to the high quality of entries.

ON AIR – Have you read any of the shortlisted books, or do you have a favourite author you're hoping will win?

BOOKS · COMING UP

3 Catherine Zeta-Jones says she based her new role as a former cocaine dealer on funny Welsh people she knows.

The actress plays Jackie Price in the upcoming film 'Kill Jackie', where her character is targeted by assassins. She revealed her inspiration during a recent interview.

ON AIR – What's your favourite Catherine Zeta-Jones movie, or what kind of role would you love to see her play next?

FILM · COMING UP

4 Rapper Macklemore has announced a 'Free Palestine' tour, with proceeds going to organisations supporting Palestinians.

The tour begins in Dublin next month, following a recent fallout with Ed Sheeran. Macklemore has been vocal about his support for the cause.

ON AIR – Do you think artists should use their platform to raise awareness for political causes?

MUSIC · COMING UP

5 An Indian film from Nagaland, 'Angh', is now on a path towards the Oscars after a major win at the Toronto Film Festival.

The film brings a rarely seen world to global cinema, telling a powerful story from northeastern India. It's hoped to be a strong contender for international awards.

ON AIR – What's the last international film you saw that really impressed you?

FILM · COMING UP

On the schedule

1 **Football finance experts say the potential sanctions for Manchester City will be 'significant' after the club was found guilty of breaking financial rules.**

Sources told the BBC that City has been found guilty of breaking the majority of the 115 financial rules they were charged with. The club has always denied any wrongdoing.

ON AIR – What do you think would be a fair punishment for Manchester City, and how might this affect the Premier League?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Warwickshire are on the brink of securing their ninth County Championship title after a dominant performance against Leicestershire.**

Centurion Sam Hain shared a huge 165-run stand with skipper Ed Barnard. They're now just a few steps away from lifting the trophy.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of county cricket, and who are you backing to win the Championship?

CRICKET · UK

3 **It's old hands versus new blood in the Super League semi-final tonight, as Wigan and Wakefield vie to reach the Grand Final.**

Wigan have substantial play-off experience, while it's new territory for their opponents Wakefield. It promises to be an exciting clash.

ON AIR – Who are you backing to win tonight's Super League semi-final, and do you think experience or fresh talent will prevail?

RUGBY LEAGUE · THIS WEEKEND

4 **Portugal have beaten Wales one-nil in their Nations League opener, with Joao Felix scoring the only goal in Lisbon.**

Wales boss Craig Bellamy believes there is 'more to come' from his side despite the loss. Liverpool forward Lewis Koumas earned praise for his efforts.

ON AIR – What did you make of Wales' performance, and how do you think they'll fare in the rest of the Nations League campaign?

FOOTBALL · UK

5 **Chelsea's Wendie Renard scored a 'glorious' long-range goal in their one-nil win against Austria Vienna in the Women's Champions League.**

It was a stunning strike that secured the victory for Chelsea in their opening group stage match. The team will be hoping to go far in the competition this season.

ON AIR – Did you see that incredible goal? What's the best goal you've seen in women's football recently?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 More of us are batch-cooking at the weekend to dodge the weeknight scramble.**
Freezers are filling with portioned dinners. The classic mistake: forgetting to label them, then playing 'mystery soup' on a Wednesday.
- 2 Cold-water taps for filling pets' bowls and watering cans are the surprise garden-centre hit.**
With more of us gardening, small convenience gadgets are booming — though the watering can remains undefeated.
- 3 The great British picnic is being upgraded, with sales of fold-out chairs and cool bags climbing.**
We're venturing out more, weather permitting. The traditional picnic still ends, as ever, with at least one item dropped in the grass.
- 4 Knitting and crochet are booming with a new generation, sold as the ultimate screen-free wind-down.**
Beginners start with scarves and quietly accumulate wool. The first project, makers admit, is usually 'a bit wonky but loved'.
- 5 A study says the average person walks past their phone over 50 times a day without picking it up.**
Researchers reckon just seeing it nearby is enough reassurance. The phone, meanwhile, remains entirely unbothered.
- 6 Allotment waiting lists have hit record highs across the UK.**
Councils in some areas now quote waits of several years. The most-grown first crop for beginners? Courgettes — closely followed by regret, as they produce far too many.
- 7 A survey finds most of us have at least one app we've never opened since downloading it.**
The average phone reportedly carries dozens of unused apps. Top of the 'meant to use it' pile: language-learning and meditation.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

- Q** 68% of us admit to keeping THIS for years even though it doesn't work. What is it?
ANSWER: A PEN WE KNOW IS DEAD, THAT WE PUT BACK IN THE DRAWER ANYWAY.
- Q** Asked the most pointless thing they do every day, Brits' number one answer was THIS.
ANSWER: CHECKING THE FRIDGE AGAIN, HOPING NEW FOOD HAS APPEARED.

TALK TOPIC

- **A survey says most of us would fail a test on the rules of a sport we watch every week.**
Which sport do you love but couldn't actually explain the rules of?
- **Apparently we all have a phrase a parent or grandparent said that we now catch ourselves saying.**
What's the saying you swore you'd never repeat — and now say constantly?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

- FACT** **Animals.** A shrimp-like creature called the mantis shrimp can throw a punch so fast it briefly boils the water around its claw, creating a flash of light. It's one of the fastest movements in the animal kingdom.
- FICTION** **Made up, but believable.** A zoo in Yorkshire has had to give its meerkats tiny sunglasses after keepers noticed they kept squinting at visitors' phone screens during photos.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£5.8 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£5.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The phrase 'raining cats and dogs' has uncertain origins, but it's been used in English for centuries.
- Wombats, koalas and kangaroos all carry their young in pouches — they're marsupials.
- A 'moment' was once an actual medieval unit of time, lasting about 90 seconds.
- The Statue of Liberty's full height to the torch is over 90 metres including the base.
- Owls can rotate their heads around 270 degrees.
- Carrots were originally purple before orange ones were cultivated.
- The fastest land animal, the cheetah, can go from standstill to motorway speeds in a few seconds.
- There's a species of jellyfish considered biologically 'immortal', able to revert to an earlier life stage.

On this day

Day 269 of the year, 96 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast days: Canadian Martyrs (Catholic Church in Canada); Christian feast days: Cosmas and Damian; Christian feast days: Blessed Crescencia Valls Espí; Christian feast days: John of Meda. Star sign Libra, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1975 — Jake Paltrow, American director and screenwriter
- 1989 — Jonny Bairstow, English cricketer
- 1973 — Julianne Davis, American actress, producer, and screenwriter
- 1962 — Tracey Thorn, English singer-songwriter and writer
- 1973 — Chris Small, Scottish snooker player and coach
- 1969 — Paul Warhurst, English footballer and manager
- 1968 — Jim Caviezel, American actor
- 1956 — Linda Hamilton, American actress

THE DAY TODAY

- 2002 — The overcrowded Senegalese ferry, MV Le Joola, capsizes off the coast of the Gambia killing more than 1,000.
- 1933 — As gangster Machine Gun Kelly surrenders to the FBI, he shouts out, "Don't shoot, G-Men!", which becomes a nickname for FBI agents.
- 2014 — A mass kidnapping of 43 students from a teaching college occurs in Iguala, Mexico.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2009 — Typhoon Ketsana hits the Philippines, China, Vietnam, Cambodia, Laos and Thailand, causing 700 fatalities.
- 1994 — A Yakovlev Yak-40 crashes into a river near Vanavara, Russia, killing 24.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1978 — Air Caribbean Flight 309 crashes in Residencial Las Casas in San Juan, Puerto Rico, killing six.
- 1992 — A Nigerian Air Force Lockheed C-130 Hercules crashes in Ejigbo, Lagos, killing 159.

- 1923 — The German government calls off the passive resistance to the French and Belgian occupation of the Ruhr.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 270 of the year, 95 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast days: Adheritus; Christian feast days: Bonfilii; Christian feast days: Caius of Milan; Christian feast days: Hiltrude of Liessies. Star sign Libra, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1956 — Martin Handford, English children's author and illustrator
- 1972 — Gwyneth Paltrow, American actress, blogger, and businesswoman
- 1991 — Thomas Mann, American actor
- 1948 — Les Chapman, English footballer and manager
- 1973 — Indira Varma, British actress
- 1963 — Marc Maron, American comedian, actor, and radio host
- 1978 — Brad Arnold, American singer-songwriter (died 2026)
- 1942 — Alvin Stardust, English singer and actor (died 2014)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2007 — NASA launches the Dawn probe to the asteroid belt.
- 1964 — The British TSR-2 aircraft XR219 makes its maiden flight.
- 1988 — The National League for Democracy is formed by Aung San Suu Kyi and others to fight dictatorship in Myanmar.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1949 — Zeng Liansong's design is chosen as the flag of the People's Republic of China.
- 2003 — The SMART-1 satellite is launched.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING • FILM

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar